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Contents

Introduction	1
Key takeaways	2
Momentum for European healthtech	3
Spotlight on women's health	4
Appendix	5

EMERGING TECH RESEARCH

Takeaways From the 2025 LSX World Congress

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Introduction

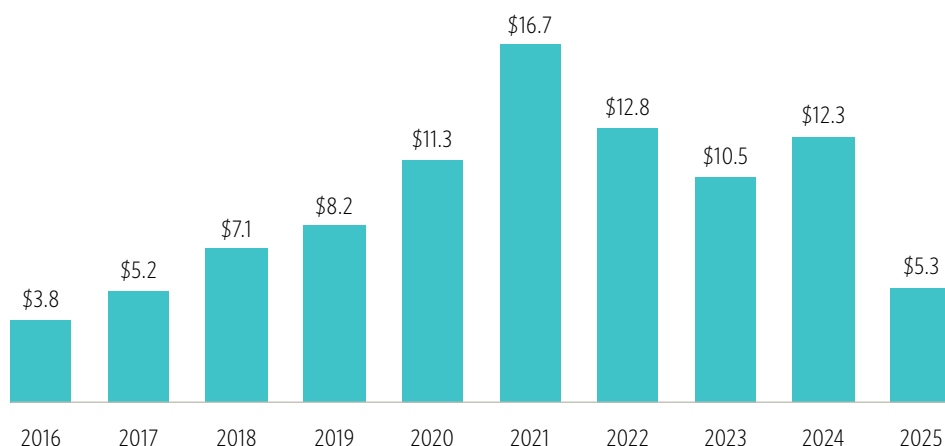
The 11th Annual LSX World Congress brought together global leaders in medtech, healthtech, and biotech for two days of networking and panel discussions at London’s Business Design Centre from April 29 to 30, 2025. Attendees were in high spirits—perhaps helped by unseasonably warm weather in London and a surprise sighting of Arsenal’s football team near the venue ahead of its Champions League match. Notably, this marks LSX’s final year in London, as the conference will move to Lisbon for its 2026 edition next March.

This year’s event brought together 1,500 executives and industry participants from startups, publicly listed companies, investors, strategics, and other key stakeholders. With programming that spanned the entire life sciences ecosystem, LSX 2025 featured dedicated speaker tracks for the medtech, healthtech, and biotech sectors, and startup showcases offered an additional platform to spotlight emerging technologies and companies. Core panel sessions explored a wide range of topics, including strategies for global expansion, startup funding decisions, leveraging AI to address health equity gaps, data privacy in life sciences, and pathways to drive new product adoption in the UK’s National Health Service.

Key takeaways

- Efficiency emerged as a key theme, with companies focused on doing more with less. Panelists discussed the potential downsides of large funding rounds, noting that they can lead to inefficiencies and occasionally lower returns for investors.
- “Don’t be the next Kodak.” In an environment where strategics are pulling back from corporate VC, Robert Kossmann from Fresenius emphasized that strategic investment could serve as a defensive tool to stay ahead of disruptive innovation.
- Investors offered valuable advice to startups during panel discussions, stressing that detractors can become your allies by providing strong feedback. Several panelists shared the view that it is crucial to understand the VC mindset when funding is declined so that startups can be positioned for a better outcome next time.
- Attendees were candid about the challenges European companies face in the current tariff-driven landscape. However, there was also optimism, with many seeing today’s market conditions as a chance to boost investment in EU and UK firms capable of challenging, or at least keeping pace, with US dominance in healthtech and life sciences.
- A central theme was positioning startups for successful partnerships with large corporates and health systems. Panelists emphasized the importance of avoiding “solutions in search of a problem,” finding the right strategic fit, and developing meaningful return on investment metrics across diverse populations and geographies.

Healthcare VC capital raised (\$B) in Europe and UK



Source: PitchBook • Geography: Europe • As of May 6, 2025

Momentum for European healthtech

While overall [healthtech VC funding](#) has cooled in recent years, Europe's top-of-funnel activity is gaining momentum—particularly among consumer-focused healthtech unicorns. Over the past year, Cera, Huma, and Flo Health all reached unicorn status, with a combined \$430 million in venture funding. Meanwhile, smart ring maker Oura secured a \$200 million round in December, pushing its valuation up to \$5.2 billion and making it one of the most highly valued digital health startups globally.

In a shift, we are seeing the European venture ecosystem form the bedrock of the next generation of consumer healthtech companies. In contrast, many of the largest digital health unicorns in the US, such as IPO candidate Hinge Health, operate in the B2B2C space and sell through payers and employers rather than in the consumer channel. While US public market investors were burned by several pandemic-era digital health IPOs (as outlined in our latest [Healthtech Public Comp Sheet and Valuation Guide](#)), Europe has been carving out a strong position in the global healthcare venture landscape. The region has also seen strong momentum in biopharma, with Novo Nordisk becoming a global heavyweight in the weight loss drug market—although its trajectory has recently slowed amid pricing pressures and rising competition.

From a broader perspective, VC funding in European and UK healthcare companies has been resilient, totaling more than \$12.3 billion in 2024—the third-highest figure on record. At LSX, much of the discussion centered on how Europe can capitalize on shifting US trade policy and declining nondomestic investment in that country to boost its own innovation ecosystem. With a growing roster of unicorns, healthy VC flows, and increasing government support, the outlook for Europe's healthtech scene is promising. That said, US market dynamics—particularly its higher margins and growth profile—remain attractive for globally minded European startups. And in areas like surgical robotics, companies such as Moon Surgical and CMR Surgical are gearing up to challenge Intuitive's dominance and aiming to scale internationally.



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Spotlight on women's health

A panel session on The State of Play of Women's Health drew strong audience participation as panelists from Thena Capital, Flo Health, Natural Cycles, and Organon tackled the chronic underfunding of women's health and the need to include gender-specific data in clinical trials. Doing so, they argued, not only improves outcomes but also helps reduce litigation risk and the likelihood of costly drug or product recalls. This session highlighted some eye-opening statistics: For example, eight out of 10 drugs withdrawn from the US market between 1997 and 2000 posed greater risks to women than men.¹ Another surprising statistic indicated the National Institutes of Health only began requiring the inclusion of female animals in funded research in 2016.² Panelists made a compelling case that the potential risk of lost business from drug recalls supports investment to ensure drugs will work just as effectively on women as men.

While panelists agreed on the importance of improving data for women's health and designing trials that reflect female populations, there was some divergence on the value of research from consumer health companies compared to traditional pharmacologic channels. Given the challenges companies such as 23andMe have faced in translating consumer health data into pharma insights, some skepticism is understandable. Still, in a sector with significant knowledge gaps among consumers, patients, and investors, even less-formal research can help drive much-needed investment and innovation in women's health.

1: "Food and Drug Administration Beyond the 2001 Government Accountability Office Report: Promoting Drug Safety for Women," *Journal of Women's Health*, Marjorie R. Jenkins, et al., February 24, 2021.

2: "Why We Know so Little About Women's Health," *AAMC*, Bridget Balch, March 28, 2024.

Appendix

Select medtech startups showcased at LSX

Company	HQ location	Total raised (\$M)	Last known valuation (\$M)	Last financing deal type	Last financing date	Last financing size (\$M)	Active investors
Elypta	Solna, Sweden	\$29.8	\$17.9	Accelerator/incubator	21 October 2024	N/A	3T Invest, Bonnier Capital, Chalmers Ventures, EIC Scaling Club, EIT Health, European Innovation Council, Hargay, Hillclimber, Horizon 2020, Industrifonden, Navigare Ventures, Nina Capital, Norrsken VC, Northislet, Sahlgrenska Science Park, Societ, The Roddenberry Foundation, Vinnova
Charco Neurotech	Cambridge, UK	\$17.5	\$19.1	Seed	27 June 2024	\$6.2	Accelerate Cambridge, Amadeus Capital Partners, Crista Galli Ventures, Grow London, Imperial College London, Imperial College London Endowment, Innovate UK, InnovationRCA, MedTech SuperConnector, Mint Venture Partners, Oxbridge Angels, Parkwalk Advisors, RCA (unknown), The Francis Crick Institute, The University of Tokyo Edge Capital
Oncobit	Schlieren, Switzerland	\$12.4	\$21.8	Late-stage VC	19 November 2024	\$5.0	Avanteca Partners, GF Group Holding, Kickfund, P4 Precision, Rudolf Gyga, University of Zürich, Venture Kick
Novai	Reading, UK	\$6.1	\$19.3	Early-stage VC	18 December, 2024	N/A	Active Capital (London), Anglia Capital Group, Ascension, Conduit Connect, Dammam Valley, ExSight Ventures, Innovate UK, No Label Ventures, SFC Capital, Startup Creosphere, SyndicateRoom, Telarik, The FSE Group
Transdermal Diagnostics	Bath, UK	\$2.0	\$5.4	Early-stage VC	27 March 2024	\$0.7	Bristol Private Equity Club, College Green Ventures, Elbow Beach Capital, Empirical Ventures, Immetric, Innovate UK, Pioneer Group (London), QUBIS, Science Angel Syndicate, UK Research and Innovation, University of Bath, West of England Local Enterprise Partnership
Eversens	Pamplona, Spain	\$1.7	\$3.6	Late-stage VC	26 January 2024	N/A	Cein, Clave, Horizon 2020, Orza (Other commercial services), Sociedad de Desarrollo de Navarra, Start Up Capital Navarra, UN I+D+i Technology Transfer fund
Meliodays	Munich, Germany	\$0.9	N/A	Seed	20 March 2025	\$0.9	Capacura, FS Life Science Investment
Redzinc	Dublin, Ireland	\$0.4	N/A	Seed	25 November 2022	\$0.8	5G PPP

Source: PitchBook • Geography: Europe • As of May 6, 2025

Select techbio³ startups showcased at LSX

Company	HQ location	Total raised (\$M)	Last known valuation (\$M)	Last financing deal type	Last financing date	Last financing size (\$M)	Active investors
Precirix	Brussels, Belgium	\$133.0	\$98.0	Late-stage VC	16 March 2022	\$89.0	BioMedPartners, Forbion, Gimv, HealthCap, Inkef, Jeito, Novo Holdings, Pontifax Venture Capital, The Brussels Institute for Research and Innovation, V-Bio Ventures, Vrije Universiteit Brussel
Iktos	Paris, France	\$21.0	\$57.5	Grant	20 February 2025	\$2.6	Agoranov, Bpifrance, Debiopharm Innovation Fund, Dominique Ferst, European Innovation Council, French Government, La Synapse, M Ventures, Omnes Capital, Paris Region Venture Fund, Salamander Invest, Wilco (Paris)
Cytomos	Edinburgh, UK	\$15.4	\$17.8	Late-stage VC	19 October 2024	\$7.8	Archangel Investors, British Business Bank, Innovate UK, Old College Capital, Scottish Enterprise
Nostics	Amsterdam, Netherlands	\$10.8	N/A	Seed	1 April 2023	\$3.4	3T Capital, DFF Ventures, Locapes Investment Fund, Percival Participations, Planet B.io
Methinks	Barcelona, Spain	\$9.2	\$7.0	Late-stage VC	N/A	N/A	Àngel Chamorro, Biocat, Coben Ventures, Demetrius Lopes, EIT Health, European Innovation Council, Grupo HS3, Lluís Donoso, Marc Ribó, Namarel Ventures, Nina Capital, Tudor Jovin
Biotx.ai	Potsdam, Germany	\$2.3	\$0.3	Accelerator/incubator	N/A	N/A	Business Angels Club Berlin-Brandenburg, Businessplan-Wettbewerb Berlin-Brandenburg, Creative Destruction Lab, Harald Pinger, Hoxton Ventures, Johnson & Johnson Innovation - JLABS, Merck Innovation Center, Oxonian Ventures, Ruppiner Kliniken, Startupbootcamp, Techcode, University of Toronto Entrepreneurship
eargym	London, UK	\$1.2	\$4.9	Early-stage VC	22 May 2024	\$0.3	Birdhouse (Antwerp), TwinklHive, Zinc
Cytecom	Coventry, UK	\$1.1	\$1.9	Accelerator/incubator	21 August 2024	N/A	ICURE, Innovate UK, Oxford Technology Management, Plug and Play Tech Center, SPARK The Midland, Texas Medical Center, The Francis Crick Institute, University of Warwick, University of Warwick Foundation, WCS Nominees, West Midlands Health Tech Innovation Accelerator

Source: PitchBook • Geography: Europe • As of May 6, 2025

³: See [Navigating the Techbio Investment Ecosystem](#) for an explainer of the techbio sector.